

Clave & Pulse Quick Reference

One chart for the clave-family patterns in 12/8 and 4/4. Every pattern is color-coded cell by cell (2-beat units): **with-clave (green)** / **counter-clave (orange)**.
(The layout switches automatically with screen width.)

How to read the symbols

- 1 2 3 4

main beats (heads of the beats) — shared by both structures
- 12/8

1 beat = 3 pulses: **1 + a**
- 4/4

1 beat = 4 pulses: **1 e + a**

	3-side (tension)						2-side (resolution)					
	Beat 1			Beat 2			Beat 3			Beat 4		

12/8 — base form each beat divides into 3 (1 + a)

	1	+	a	2	+	a	3	+	a	4	+	a
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Rhythmic foundation

Main beats	○			○			○			○		
Offbeats on “+”		●			●			●			●	
Offbeats on “a”			●			●			●			●

Cross-rhythm three against two

Six-beat cycle (secondary beats)	●		●		●		●		●		●	
Bombo / Ponche			B ₁		P ₁				B ₂		P ₂	
3:2 composite	●		●	●	●		●		●	●	●	
Offbeat 6		●		●		●		●		●		●

Practical guidelines key patterns

Standard pattern	●		●		●	●		●		●		●
Son clave	●		●		●			●		●		
Rumba clave	●		●			●		●		●		

Lead instrument counter-clave

Quinto (Columbia)		●		●		●			●		●	
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4/4 — variant form each beat divides into 4 (1 e + a)

	1	e	+	a	2	e	+	a	3	e	+	a	4	e	+	a
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Rhythmic foundation

Main beats	○				○				○				○			
Regular quarter-note count	1		2		3		4		1		2		3		4	
Offbeats on “e”		●				●				●				●		
Offbeats on “+”			●				●				●				●	
Offbeats on “a”				●				●				●				●

Cross-rhythm three against two

Tresillo	●			●			●		●			●			●	
Bombo / Ponche				B ₁			P ₁					B ₂			P ₂	
Habanera / 3:2 composite	●			●	●		●		●			●	●		●	
Displaced tresillo			●		●			●		●			●			●
On-beat eighths	●		●		●		●		●		●		●		●	
Off-beat eighths		●		●		●		●		●		●		●		●

Practical guidelines key patterns

Standard pattern	●			●			●	●		●		●				●
Son clave	●			●			●			●		●				
Rumba clave	●			●				●		●		●				

Lead instrument counter-clave

Quinto (Guaguancó)		●			●			●			●		●			
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Summary — function map of the 16 slots 3-2 son clave + quinto (right after each stroke) + borrowings from the opposite side + dual-role points: all 16 slots have a role

Function of every slot	●	▲	■	●	▲■	×	●	▲■◆	■	×	●	▲■	●	▲	■	◆
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■ with-clave cells ■ counter-clave cells uncolored = foundation / raw material ○ / numbers = reference beats — ● = strokes — B = bombo, P = ponche

Function map: ● clave — ▲ quinto = right after clave — ■ borrowed counter — ◆ dual role — × empty